3–2 win in the ODI series.

The team is performing well and I am doing just about enough to stay in it. We fly home and secure two emphatic Test victories over the touring New Zealanders, winning by 358 runs in Johannesburg and then by an innings and 59 runs at Centurion. We then win both a T20 international and the ODI series 2–1.

A spirited West Indies team provided our opposition in the second half of the home summer and they surprised us in the first Test in Port Elizabeth before we recovered to win Tests in Cape Town and Durban and nail down a 2–1 series win. We won a single T20 international and then completed a 5–0 sweep in the ODI series.

For my part, I scored half-centuries in each innings of the first Test, then made an unbeaten 103 in our dominant first innings of the third Test in Durban. I had decided to try a new trigger movement, which involved stepping back and across my stumps as the ball is bowled; it felt awkward at first, but I settled into it and managed to pull Jerome Taylor for four to bring up my century just before Graeme declared. There followed decent innings of 45 and 77 during the ODI series, and I was starting to feel reasonably comfortable again.

As one series led to another, I remained figuratively at the crossroads, still building a proper defensive technique and still needing to create an organised and professional support system. Days became weeks, weeks became months and, somehow, despite the best intentions, nothing got done. Two well-known agents had said they would like to represent and manage me, and I needed to choose between them.

Then, out of the blue, my career began to move in a new, unexpected and unusual direction.

Early one Saturday morning I boarded a flight from OR Tambo airport in Johannesburg to Cape Town, where I was required for a commercial appearance with the Proteas. I had been out with some friends most of